

Meridian Global Holdings, Inc.

Human Resources Policy Manual

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This document is provided for internal use and Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) testing purposes. It contains illustrative policy content for a fictional organization.

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1. Introduction and Purpose

1.1 Purpose of This Handbook

This Human Resources Policy Manual ('the Manual') sets out the employment policies, procedures, and standards of conduct that apply to all employees of Meridian Global Holdings, Inc. ('the Company', 'Meridian'), across all subsidiaries, business units, and geographic locations, except where local law requires a variation, in which case the locally compliant version shall prevail. The Manual is intended to provide a single, authoritative reference point for managers and employees alike, reducing ambiguity in the application of workplace rules and ensuring that decisions about hiring, compensation, discipline, leave, and separation are made consistently and fairly across the organization.

1.2 Scope and Applicability

This Manual applies to all full-time, part-time, temporary, and fixed-term employees, as well as to interns and secondees, unless a specific policy states otherwise. Independent contractors and consultants engaged under separate service agreements are not covered by this Manual, except where explicitly referenced in their contracts. Where a country-specific addendum exists, that addendum takes precedence over the general provisions contained here for employees based in that country.

1.3 Policy Review and Amendment

The Company reserves the right to amend, suspend, or withdraw any policy in this Manual at any time, with or without notice, subject to applicable law and any consultation obligations owed to employee representative bodies. The Human Resources department is responsible for maintaining the master version of this Manual and for communicating material changes to employees within thirty (30) days of adoption. Employees are responsible for familiarizing themselves with the most current version, which is published on the internal HR portal.

1.4 Relationship to Employment Contracts

In the event of a conflict between an individual's signed employment contract and this Manual, the terms of the employment contract will prevail. Where the employment contract is silent on a matter addressed in this Manual, the Manual's provisions will apply as an implied term of employment, to the extent permitted by law.

2. Recruitment and Selection

2.1 Equal Opportunity Recruitment

Meridian is committed to recruiting on the basis of merit, competence, and business need. All vacancies are advertised through approved channels and evaluated using standardized, job-related criteria. Hiring managers must not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, marital status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law.

2.2 Job Requisitions and Approvals

All new or replacement positions must be initiated via a job requisition form approved by the hiring manager's direct supervisor and the relevant HR Business Partner. Requisitions must include an updated job description, salary band, and justification for headcount. No offer of employment may be extended until the requisition has received final budgetary sign-off from Finance.

2.3 Interview Process

A minimum of two structured interviews is required for all permanent hires, at least one of which must include a panel of two or more interviewers. Interview questions should be drawn from the approved competency framework for the role, and interviewers must complete a scorecard within 48 hours of each interview to support consistent, documented decision-making and to reduce the risk of unconscious bias.

2.4 Background Checks and References

All offers of employment are conditional upon satisfactory completion of background screening, which may include verification of identity, right-to-work status, prior employment, educational qualifications, and, where relevant to the role, credit history or criminal record checks, always subject to applicable local law and with the candidate's informed consent. At least two professional references must be obtained before a start date is confirmed.

2.5 Offer Letters and Onboarding

Offer letters are issued by HR and must not be varied by hiring managers without HR approval. Newly hired employees will complete a structured 90-day onboarding program, including orientation, systems access provisioning, completion of mandatory compliance training, and a 30/60/90-day check-in with their manager.

2.6 Internal Mobility and Referrals

Current employees are encouraged to apply for internal vacancies after completing a minimum of twelve (12) months in their current role, unless otherwise agreed with their manager. Employees who refer successful external candidates are eligible for a referral bonus, paid in two installments: 50% upon the referred candidate's start date and 50% upon completion of their probationary period.

3. Employment Classifications

3.1 Full-Time Employees

Full-time employees are those regularly scheduled to work at least 37.5 hours per week (or the local statutory equivalent). Full-time employees are eligible for the full suite of Company benefits described in Section 8, subject to any applicable waiting periods.

3.2 Part-Time Employees

Part-time employees work fewer than the standard full-time hours on a regular, ongoing basis. Part-time employees receive benefits on a pro-rated basis proportional to their scheduled hours, except where local law mandates full entitlement regardless of hours worked.

3.3 Fixed-Term and Temporary Employees

Fixed-term employees are engaged for a specific period or project and are notified in writing of the anticipated end date at the outset of their engagement. Extensions or conversions to permanent status must be approved by HR and documented via an amended contract.

3.4 Interns and Trainees

Interns are engaged for a defined learning period, typically ranging from eight to twenty-four weeks, and are assigned a workplace mentor. Interns are not eligible for the Company's discretionary bonus scheme but do accrue paid leave in accordance with local statutory minimums.

3.5 Independent Contractors

Individuals engaged as independent contractors are not employees of the Company and are not covered by this Manual. Managers must consult HR and Legal before engaging any individual on a contractor basis to ensure correct worker classification and to avoid misclassification risk.

4. Working Hours, Attendance, and Overtime

4.1 Standard Working Hours

The Company's standard working week is 37.5 hours, typically structured as 9:00 a.m. to 5:30 p.m., Monday to Friday, with a one-hour unpaid lunch break, unless a different schedule is specified in an employee's contract or required by local law. Core collaboration hours, during which all employees are expected to be reachable, are 10:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. local time.

4.2 Flexible Working Arrangements

Employees may request flexible working arrangements, including flexible start and finish times, compressed workweeks, or job-sharing, by submitting a Flexible Working Request Form to their manager. Requests will be assessed within twenty-one (21) days based on operational feasibility, and any agreed arrangement will be documented in writing and reviewed after a three-month trial period.

4.3 Attendance and Punctuality

Employees are expected to attend work as scheduled and to notify their manager as soon as reasonably possible, and in any case before the start of the working day, if they will be absent or late. Patterns of unauthorized absence or persistent lateness will be addressed through the performance management process described in Section 11.

4.4 Overtime

Non-exempt employees who are required to work beyond their standard scheduled hours are entitled to overtime pay or compensatory time off in accordance with local law and the applicable overtime policy for their jurisdiction. Overtime must be pre-authorized by the employee's manager except in genuine emergencies, in which case it must be reported retrospectively within 48 hours.

4.5 Timekeeping

All employees must accurately record their hours worked using the Company's timekeeping system, Meridian TimeTrack, by the end of each pay period. Falsification of time records, including recording time not actually worked or asking a colleague to clock in on one's behalf, is treated as gross misconduct under Section 13.

5. Remote and Hybrid Work

5.1 Eligibility

Roles that do not require regular on-site presence may be eligible for hybrid or fully remote arrangements, subject to manager approval and demonstrated performance. Eligibility is reviewed at least annually and may be revoked where business needs change or performance concerns arise.

5.2 Home Office Standards

Employees working remotely are responsible for maintaining a safe, ergonomic, and confidential workspace. The Company will provide a one-time home office stipend of up to \$500 (or local currency equivalent) for approved equipment, and a laptop, headset, and any role-specific hardware will be issued by IT.

5.3 Data Security While Working Remotely

Remote employees must connect to Company systems only via the approved VPN, must not use personal devices to store confidential Company data, and must ensure that screens are not visible to unauthorized persons, including household members, during video calls involving confidential information.

5.4 In-Office Expectations for Hybrid Roles

Employees on hybrid arrangements are expected to attend the office on their designated anchor days, currently Tuesday and Thursday for most business units, unless otherwise specified by their department. Attendance is tracked via badge access and reviewed quarterly by department heads.

5.5 International Remote Work

Employees wishing to work remotely from a country other than their country of employment for more than ten consecutive business days must obtain prior written approval from HR, Legal, and Tax, given the potential implications for immigration status, payroll tax, and permanent establishment risk to the Company.

6. Leave and Time Off

6.1 Annual (Vacation) Leave

Full-time employees accrue 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to statutory public holidays observed in their home location. Leave accrues monthly and must generally be taken within the calendar year in which it accrues; up to 5 unused days may be carried over into the following year with manager approval, and must be used by March 31 or they will be forfeited, except where local law requires otherwise.

6.2 Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to up to 10 fully paid sick days per calendar year for personal illness or injury, with a medical certificate required for absences exceeding three consecutive working days. Extended illness beyond the paid sick leave entitlement may be covered under the Company's short-term or long-term disability programs described in Section 8.6.

6.3 Parental Leave

Birth parents are entitled to 16 weeks of paid maternity leave, and non-birth parents are entitled to 6 weeks of paid parental leave, both payable at 100% of base salary, in addition to any statutory entitlements in the employee's jurisdiction, whichever is greater. Employees intending to take parental leave should notify HR at least eight weeks before the expected start date wherever possible.

6.4 Bereavement Leave

Employees may take up to 5 paid days of bereavement leave upon the death of an immediate family member (spouse, partner, child, parent, or sibling), and up to 2 paid days for the death of an extended family member. Additional unpaid leave may be granted at the manager's discretion.

6.5 Jury Duty and Civic Leave

Employees summoned for jury duty or subpoenaed as a witness will receive their normal pay for the duration of their civic obligation, less any fees paid directly to the employee by the court, upon presentation of appropriate documentation.

6.6 Sabbatical Leave

Employees with 5 or more years of continuous service are eligible to apply for unpaid sabbatical leave of up to 3 months, subject to business need and manager approval. A written return-to-work agreement must be signed prior to commencement of the sabbatical, confirming the employee's role and seniority upon return.

6.7 Unpaid Leave of Absence

In exceptional circumstances, employees may request an unpaid leave of absence of up to 6 months. Such requests are evaluated on a case-by-case basis and require approval from both the employee's manager

and HR. Benefits continuation during unpaid leave is governed by the specific terms outlined in the leave approval letter.

7. Compensation and Payroll

7.1 Pay Structure and Salary Bands

Meridian maintains a job-leveling framework with defined salary bands for each level and function, benchmarked annually against relevant market data. Individual compensation within a band reflects experience, performance, and internal equity considerations, as reviewed by the Compensation Committee.

7.2 Pay Frequency

Employees are paid monthly, in arrears, on the last business day of each month, via direct deposit to the bank account on file. Where the last business day falls on a public holiday, payment will be made on the preceding business day.

7.3 Annual Compensation Review

Salaries are formally reviewed once per year, typically effective April 1, taking into account individual performance ratings, market movement, and Company-wide budget guidance. Compensation adjustments outside of the annual cycle require Vice President-level approval and a documented business justification.

7.4 Discretionary Bonus Scheme

Eligible employees may participate in the Company's discretionary annual bonus scheme, with target bonus percentages defined by job level and communicated at the start of each fiscal year. Bonus payments are contingent on both Company performance against financial targets and individual performance ratings, and are not guaranteed in any given year.

7.5 Overtime and Shift Premiums

Where applicable under local law and role classification, overtime is paid at 1.5 times the base hourly rate for hours worked beyond the standard schedule, and at 2 times the base hourly rate for hours worked on public holidays. Shift premiums for night or weekend work are set out in the relevant local addendum.

7.6 Deductions and Garnishments

The Company will make statutory deductions from pay as required by law, including tax withholding and social security contributions. Any deduction not required by law, such as recovery of a salary overpayment, will only be made with the employee's written consent or as otherwise permitted by applicable law.

7.7 Expense Reimbursement

Employees will be reimbursed for reasonable, pre-approved business expenses incurred in the performance of their duties, submitted via the Concur expense system within 30 days of the expense being incurred, accompanied by original itemized receipts. Expenses submitted more than 90 days after being incurred will generally not be reimbursed.

8. Employee Benefits

8.1 Health Insurance

Full-time employees and their eligible dependents may enroll in the Company's group health insurance plan beginning on the first day of the month following 30 days of employment. The Company subsidizes 80% of the premium for employee-only coverage and 60% of the premium for dependent coverage.

8.2 Dental and Vision Coverage

Supplemental dental and vision plans are available on an opt-in basis, fully funded by the employee through payroll deduction, with the Company negotiating preferential group rates on the employee's behalf.

8.3 Retirement Savings Plan

Employees are automatically enrolled in the Company's defined-contribution retirement plan after 90 days of employment, with the option to opt out. The Company matches employee contributions dollar-for-dollar up to 4% of base salary, with immediate vesting of both employee and matching contributions.

8.4 Life and Disability Insurance

The Company provides Company-paid basic life insurance equal to one times annual base salary, and short-term and long-term disability coverage replacing 60% of base salary during an approved period of disability, subject to the terms of the applicable insurance policy.

8.5 Employee Assistance Program (EAP)

All employees and their immediate household members have access to the Company's confidential Employee Assistance Program, offering up to 6 free counseling sessions per issue per year, along with legal and financial consultation services, available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.

8.6 Wellness Benefits

Employees may claim up to \$600 per calendar year toward gym memberships, fitness classes, or wellness applications through the Wellness Reimbursement Program, and are eligible to participate in quarterly on-site wellness events, including biometric screenings and mental health workshops.

8.7 Tuition and Professional Development Reimbursement

The Company will reimburse up to \$5,000 per calendar year for approved tuition, certification, or professional development expenses directly related to an employee's current or reasonably anticipated future role, subject to prior manager and HR approval and a minimum grade requirement of B or equivalent for academic coursework.

9. Health, Safety, and Workplace Environment

9.1 General Safety Responsibilities

The Company is committed to providing a safe and healthy working environment in compliance with applicable occupational health and safety legislation. Employees are responsible for following safety procedures, using provided protective equipment correctly, and reporting hazards or unsafe conditions promptly to their manager or the Health and Safety Committee.

9.2 Incident and Injury Reporting

Any workplace injury, illness, or near-miss, however minor, must be reported to a manager and logged in the Incident Reporting System within 24 hours. Serious incidents must be reported immediately, and the affected area may be secured pending investigation.

9.3 Emergency Procedures

Each office maintains posted evacuation routes, designated assembly points, and trained fire wardens. Fire drills are conducted at least twice per year, and all employees are required to participate.

9.4 Ergonomics

The Company provides ergonomic workstation assessments upon request, and will make reasonable adjustments to seating, lighting, and equipment to reduce the risk of musculoskeletal injury, in consultation with the employee's manager and, where appropriate, an occupational health advisor.

9.5 Workplace Violence Prevention

The Company maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward threats or acts of violence in the workplace, including verbal threats, intimidation, and physical altercations. Any employee who becomes aware of a potential threat must report it immediately to Security and HR; retaliation against a good-faith reporter is strictly prohibited.

9.6 Substance Use

Employees must not report to work, or remain at work, under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs. Moderate consumption of alcohol at Company-sponsored events is permitted, provided employees continue to conduct themselves professionally and do not operate a motor vehicle while impaired.

10. Equal Opportunity, Diversity, and Anti-Harassment

10.1 Equal Employment Opportunity

Meridian is an equal opportunity employer and prohibits discrimination and harassment of any kind based on race, color, sex, religion, sexual orientation, national origin, disability, genetic information, pregnancy, age, marital status, veteran status, or any other status protected by applicable federal, state, or local law. This policy applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, hiring, promotion, termination, compensation, and access to training.

10.2 Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Commitment

The Company believes that diverse teams drive better outcomes and is committed to building an inclusive culture where employees of all backgrounds can thrive. This commitment is reflected in structured, bias-aware hiring practices, employee resource groups, inclusive leadership training for people managers, and regular pay equity audits reviewed by the Compensation Committee.

10.3 Anti-Harassment Policy

Harassment of any employee, contractor, client, or visitor by another employee, based on a protected characteristic, is strictly prohibited. Harassment includes unwelcome conduct, whether verbal, physical, or visual, that creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive working environment, including but not limited to offensive jokes, slurs, unwelcome physical contact, and the display of offensive materials.

10.4 Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment, including unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature, is expressly prohibited, regardless of whether it is direct, quid pro quo, or contributes to a hostile work environment. This prohibition applies regardless of the gender of the harasser or the person harassed.

10.5 Complaint Procedure

Any employee who believes they have experienced or witnessed harassment or discrimination should report the matter to their manager, any member of HR, or via the confidential Ethics Hotline. All complaints will be investigated promptly, thoroughly, and, to the extent possible, confidentially. Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith or participates in an investigation is strictly prohibited and will itself be treated as a disciplinary matter.

10.6 Reasonable Accommodation

The Company will provide reasonable accommodation to qualified employees with disabilities, and to employees whose sincerely held religious beliefs require accommodation, unless doing so would impose an undue hardship on the Company. Employees seeking an accommodation should contact HR to begin an interactive dialogue about possible options.

11. Performance Management

11.1 Performance Philosophy

Meridian's performance management approach is designed to align individual contributions with business goals, provide regular and constructive feedback, and support employee growth. Performance is assessed on both what is achieved (outcomes) and how it is achieved (values and behaviors).

11.2 Goal Setting

At the start of each fiscal year, employees and their managers collaboratively set 3 to 5 measurable performance objectives, aligned to team and Company priorities, recorded in the Meridian Performance Portal. Goals should be reviewed and, where necessary, adjusted at the mid-year checkpoint.

11.3 Ongoing Feedback and Check-Ins

Managers are expected to hold at least one structured one-on-one meeting with each direct report per month, focused on progress against goals, development needs, and any obstacles requiring support. Ad hoc feedback should be given in real time wherever possible, rather than reserved solely for formal review periods.

11.4 Annual Performance Review

A formal, written performance review is conducted annually for all employees who have completed at least six months of service, incorporating self-assessment, manager assessment, and, for people managers, upward and peer feedback. Performance ratings directly inform compensation review, promotion eligibility, and development planning.

11.5 Performance Improvement Plans

Where an employee's performance falls below the expected standard, the manager, in consultation with HR, will implement a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) setting out specific, measurable improvement goals, the support to be provided, and a review timeline, typically 30, 60, or 90 days. Failure to achieve the goals set out in a PIP may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

11.6 Promotions and Career Development

Promotions are considered as part of the annual review cycle, or on an off-cycle basis where a significant, sustained change in scope and responsibility has occurred. All promotions require approval from the employee's manager, the relevant function head, and HR, and must fit within an approved and budgeted role at the next level.

12. Training and Development

12.1 Mandatory Compliance Training

All employees must complete mandatory compliance training modules, including Code of Conduct, Anti-Harassment, Data Protection, and Anti-Bribery and Corruption, within 30 days of hire and annually thereafter. Completion rates are tracked centrally and reported to the Audit and Risk Committee.

12.2 Manager Development Programs

Newly promoted people managers are required to complete the Meridian Leadership Foundations program within their first 90 days in a management role, covering topics such as effective delegation, performance conversations, and inclusive team leadership.

12.3 Learning and Development Budget

Each business unit maintains an annual learning and development budget, which employees may access, subject to manager approval, for conferences, certifications, and external training courses relevant to their role or career development plan.

12.4 Succession Planning

The Company conducts an annual talent and succession review for all senior leadership and business-critical roles, identifying high-potential employees and creating individualized development plans to prepare them for future opportunities within the organization.

13. Standards of Conduct and Discipline

13.1 Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and professionalism in all dealings with colleagues, customers, suppliers, and the public, and to comply with all applicable laws and Company policies. The full Code of Conduct is available on the HR portal and must be acknowledged annually by all employees.

13.2 Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid situations in which their personal interests conflict, or could reasonably appear to conflict, with the interests of the Company, including outside employment, financial interests in competitors or suppliers, and hiring or supervising close relatives. Any potential conflict must be disclosed to HR using the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form.

13.3 Gifts and Business Courtesies

Employees may accept or offer modest, occasional business courtesies consistent with local custom and Company policy, but must not accept or offer gifts, entertainment, or hospitality intended to influence, or that could reasonably appear to influence, a business decision. Any gift with an estimated value over \$100 must be reported to the employee's manager and logged in the Gift Register.

13.4 Confidentiality and Intellectual Property

Employees must protect the confidentiality of Company proprietary information, trade secrets, and personal data to which they have access, both during and after their employment. Work product created within the scope of employment, including inventions, designs, and written materials, belongs to the Company, subject to applicable law and the terms of the employee's contract.

13.5 Categories of Misconduct

Minor misconduct (e.g., occasional lateness, minor policy breaches) is typically addressed through informal coaching or a verbal warning. Serious misconduct (e.g., repeated policy violations, insubordination) may result in a written or final written warning. Gross misconduct (e.g., theft, fraud, violence, serious harassment, falsification of records, or serious breach of confidentiality) may result in summary dismissal without prior warning.

13.6 Disciplinary Procedure

Where disciplinary action is warranted, the Company will generally follow a fair process comprising: (1) investigation, (2) a disciplinary hearing at which the employee may be accompanied by a colleague or, where applicable, a union representative, (3) a written outcome decision, and (4) a right of appeal to a more senior manager not previously involved in the case, to be exercised within 10 working days of the outcome being communicated.

13.7 Suspension

The Company may suspend an employee on full pay, on a precautionary and non-disciplinary basis, while an investigation into alleged serious misconduct is conducted. Suspension is not a form of disciplinary action and does not imply that any wrongdoing has occurred.

14. Grievance Procedure

14.1 Informal Resolution

Employees are encouraged, where appropriate and where they feel comfortable doing so, to first raise workplace concerns informally and directly with the person or persons involved, or with their manager, with a view to reaching an early resolution.

14.2 Formal Grievance

Where informal resolution is not appropriate or has not resolved the matter, an employee may raise a formal written grievance to HR, setting out the nature of the complaint and the outcome sought. HR will acknowledge receipt within 3 working days and aim to convene a grievance meeting within 10 working days.

14.3 Grievance Investigation and Outcome

The grievance will be investigated by a manager not directly involved in the matter, who will issue a written outcome within 15 working days of the grievance meeting, wherever reasonably practicable, setting out any findings and actions to be taken.

14.4 Appeal

An employee who is dissatisfied with the outcome of a formal grievance may appeal in writing within 10 working days, and the appeal will be heard by a more senior manager who was not involved in the original investigation or decision.

15. Data Protection and IT Acceptable Use

15.1 Data Protection Principles

The Company collects, processes, and stores personal data relating to employees, customers, and other individuals in accordance with applicable data protection law, including principles of lawfulness, purpose limitation, data minimization, accuracy, storage limitation, and security.

15.2 Employee Data

Employee personal data is used for purposes directly related to the employment relationship, including payroll, benefits administration, performance management, and legal compliance. Employees may request access to their own personal data held by the Company by submitting a request to HR.

15.3 Acceptable Use of Company Systems

Company IT systems, including email, internet access, and collaboration tools, are provided primarily for business purposes. Limited, reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work duties, does not involve illegal, offensive, or inappropriate content, and does not create legal or reputational risk for the Company.

15.4 Information Security

Employees must use strong, unique passwords, enable multi-factor authentication where available, lock their workstation when unattended, and report any suspected security incident, including phishing attempts, to the IT Security team immediately via the 'Report Phishing' button or the IT Service Desk.

15.5 Monitoring

The Company reserves the right to monitor use of its IT systems, including email and internet activity, to the extent permitted by applicable law, for purposes including security, compliance, and business continuity. Such monitoring will be conducted proportionately and in accordance with the Company's Data Protection Policy.

15.6 Social Media Policy

Employees are personally responsible for the content they publish on social media. Employees must not disclose confidential Company information, must not present personal opinions as the views of the Company, and are encouraged to include a disclaimer when discussing industry topics in a personal capacity.

16. Business Travel and Expenses

16.1 Travel Authorization

All business travel must be pre-approved by the employee's manager and booked through the Company's approved travel management platform, except in jurisdictions where no such platform is available, in which case receipts must be retained for reimbursement.

16.2 Travel Class and Accommodation Standards

Domestic flights under 5 hours should be booked in economy class; international flights over 6 hours may be booked in premium economy or business class with manager approval. Hotel accommodation should not exceed the Company's per-diem guideline for the relevant city, as published on the Travel Policy page of the HR portal.

16.3 Meal and Incidental Per Diems

Employees traveling on Company business are entitled to a daily meal per diem, set by destination city and updated annually, in lieu of submitting individual meal receipts, unless the employee prefers to submit actual itemized receipts.

16.4 Ground Transportation

Employees should use the most cost-effective reasonable means of ground transportation, including public transit, ride-share services, or rental cars, and should avoid unnecessary use of premium car services except where safety considerations, such as late-night travel, warrant it.

17. Termination of Employment

17.1 Resignation

Employees wishing to resign should provide written notice in accordance with the notice period specified in their employment contract, typically 4 weeks for individual contributors and 8 weeks for managers and senior leaders, unless local law specifies a different minimum.

17.2 Termination by the Company

The Company may terminate employment for reasons including redundancy, poor performance following a documented Performance Improvement Plan, or misconduct, in each case following the applicable procedure set out in this Manual and in compliance with local employment law.

17.3 Notice Periods and Pay in Lieu

The Company may, at its discretion, provide pay in lieu of notice instead of requiring the employee to work their full notice period. During any notice period, the Company may place the employee on garden leave, relieving them of active duties while remaining employed and paid.

17.4 Redundancy

Where a role is made redundant due to genuine business, operational, or organizational reasons, the Company will follow a fair selection process based on objective criteria, consult with affected employees, and provide severance pay in accordance with the Company's redundancy policy and applicable local law.

17.5 Exit Process

Departing employees are required to complete a structured offboarding process, including return of Company property, revocation of system access on the last working day, and, where offered, participation in an exit interview to gather feedback for continuous improvement of the employee experience.

17.6 Final Pay and References

Final pay, including accrued but untaken annual leave, will be processed in the next available payroll cycle following the termination date, or sooner where required by local law. The Company's standard policy is to provide neutral employment references confirming job title and dates of employment, unless the departing employee requests, and HR agrees to provide, a more detailed reference.

18. Whistleblowing and Ethics

18.1 Ethics Hotline

The Company maintains a confidential, independently operated Ethics Hotline, available by phone and web form 24 hours a day, through which employees may report suspected violations of law, regulation, or Company policy, including fraud, financial irregularities, and health and safety concerns.

18.2 Anonymous Reporting

Reports may be made anonymously where permitted by local law, though the Company encourages employees to identify themselves where comfortable doing so, as this can assist with a more thorough investigation.

18.3 Non-Retaliation

The Company strictly prohibits retaliation against any employee who, in good faith, reports a concern or participates in an investigation, even where the concern is not ultimately substantiated. Any employee found to have engaged in retaliation will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

18.4 Investigation Process

Reports received through the Ethics Hotline are triaged by the Ethics and Compliance team, and, where warranted, investigated by an appropriately independent party. Investigation outcomes are reported to the Audit and Risk Committee on a quarterly basis, in aggregate and anonymized form.

19. Anti-Bribery, Corruption, and Trade Compliance

19.1 Anti-Bribery Policy

The Company strictly prohibits bribery and corruption in all its forms, whether involving public officials or private individuals, and whether the Company would be advantaged directly or indirectly. This prohibition applies globally, regardless of local custom or practice, and regardless of whether the conduct would be legal in the relevant jurisdiction.

19.2 Facilitation Payments

Facilitation payments, being small payments made to expedite routine governmental action, are prohibited, except in the rare circumstance where such a payment is required to protect the health or safety of an employee, in which case it must be reported to Legal and Compliance immediately following the incident.

19.3 Third-Party Due Diligence

Before engaging agents, distributors, or other third-party intermediaries in higher-risk markets, the responsible business unit must complete a risk-based due diligence review coordinated by the Compliance function.

19.4 Export Controls and Sanctions

Employees must comply with all applicable export control and economic sanctions laws, and must not engage in any transaction, directly or indirectly, with individuals, entities, or countries subject to applicable trade sanctions, without prior clearance from the Legal department.

20. General Provisions

20.1 Acknowledgment of Policies

All employees are required to formally acknowledge, via the HR portal, that they have read, understood, and agree to comply with this Manual, both upon hire and following any material update.

20.2 Severability

If any provision of this Manual is found to be invalid or unenforceable in a particular jurisdiction, the remaining provisions will continue in full force and effect, and the invalid provision will be replaced with a valid provision that most closely reflects the original intent.

20.3 No Contract of Employment

Except where local law provides otherwise, this Manual does not constitute a contract of employment and does not alter the at-will nature of employment where applicable. Nothing in this Manual should be construed as a guarantee of continued employment for any specific duration.

20.4 Questions and Contact

Employees with questions about any policy contained in this Manual should contact their assigned HR Business Partner, or submit a query through the HR Service Desk portal, available at hr.meridianglobal.example/help.

Appendices

Appendix A — Leave Entitlement Summary

Leave Type	Entitlement	Paid/Unpaid	Notice Required
Annual Leave	25 days/year	Paid	2 weeks (where possible)
Sick Leave	10 days/year	Paid	As soon as possible
Maternity Leave	16 weeks	Paid (100%)	8 weeks
Non-Birth Parental Leave	6 weeks	Paid (100%)	8 weeks
Bereavement (Immediate Family)	5 days	Paid	As soon as possible
Bereavement (Extended Family)	2 days	Paid	As soon as possible
Jury Duty	As required	Paid	Upon receipt of summons
Sabbatical	Up to 3 months	Unpaid	3 months
Unpaid Leave of Absence	Up to 6 months	Unpaid	4 weeks

Appendix B — Benefits Overview

Benefit	Company Contribution	Eligibility
Health Insurance	80% employee / 60% dependents	First of month after 30 days
Dental & Vision	Employee-funded, group rate	First of month after 30 days
Retirement Plan	100% match up to 4% of salary	After 90 days
Life Insurance	1x annual base salary	First of month after 30 days
Disability Insurance	60% salary replacement	First of month after 30 days
EAP	Fully Company-funded	Day one
Wellness Reimbursement	Up to \$600/year	Day one
Tuition Reimbursement	Up to \$5,000/year	After 6 months

Appendix C — Disciplinary Escalation Ladder

Stage	Typical Trigger	Outcome	Duration on File
Informal Coaching	First minor issue	Documented conversation	6 months
Verbal Warning	Repeated minor issue	Formal verbal warning letter	6 months

Stage	Typical Trigger	Outcome	Duration on File
Written Warning	Serious or repeated issue	Written warning + improvement plan	12 months
Final Written Warning	Continued failure to improve	Final warning; dismissal risk stated	12 months
Dismissal	Gross misconduct or PIP failure	Termination of employment	Permanent record

Appendix D — Policy Acknowledgment Form

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Meridian Global Holdings, Inc. Human Resources Policy Manual (Version 4.2). I understand that this Manual is subject to change and that I am responsible for reviewing updates as they are communicated. I understand that this Manual does not constitute a contract of employment.

Employee Name: _____ Employee ID: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____